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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM
MGU-UGP (Honours)/ MGU-BBA (Honours)/ MGU-BCA (Honours) REGULAR EXAMINATION, October 2026
Fifth Semester
DSE: MG5DSEENGA00: Conflict Zone Literatures: Memory, Identity, and Resistance.
(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 hours **Maximum Marks: 70**

Scheme for Valuation

Part A - MCQ

Answer all questions. Each question carries **1** mark

1. b). Power dynamics between order-givers and order-takers **CO1**
2. a). A permanent status of the society **CO1**
3. c). An elimination of an absolute threat to the state's survival **CO2**
4. c). The proliferation of private military forces, militias, and warlords **CO2**
5. c). The permanent suspension of law to exercise state violence legally **CO2**
6. c). That his immense parental love is entirely powerless against the indifferent forces of nature**.** **CO3**
7. c). Collective psychological trauma and the absence left by the lost **CO3**
8. b). The narrator's son, Marwan **CO3**
9. d). A piece of traditional embroidery **CO4**
10. b). As a small protest which changed nothing. **CO4**

(1x10=10)

Part B - Short Answer

Answer any **6** questions. Each question carries **5** marks

11. In state vs. non-state asymmetric warfare, the civilian population is the battlefield-When the professional army cannot distinguish between a combatant and a civilian, the spatial boundaries of war dissolve. - The conflict enters everyday spaces-markets, hospitals, and homes-becoming a general social condition. - Guerrillas, insurgents, and terrorists do not wear uniforms or operate from distinct military bases. They are deeply embedded within the populace **CO1**

12. In Phil Klay's Redeployment- returning home from a war zone does not signify a true return to peace or normalcy- conditioned by hyper-vigilance, trauma, and the rules of engagement of the battlefield-treating everyday life like an ongoing theatre of war**.** **CO2**

13. In military contexts, survival relies on an absolute, instinctive symbiosis between the soldier and their weapon. The rifle ceases to be an external tool and becomes a vital sensory organ-totalizing modern warfare is—shaping not just the soldier's ideology, but their physical posture and psychological identity, making it difficult to shed the military identity. **CO2**

14. Refaat Alareer's poem- the kite represents childhood, innocence, play, and the soaring aspiration of human freedom-The tail of the kite signifies connection, balance, and the transmission of hope across generations. By mentioning a child who looks up to see the kite, the poem emphasizes that hope is never lost. **CO2**

15. Mags is the narrator's Friend-New York City in the immediate aftermath of the September 11 attacks, the narrator believes Mags is suffering from intense psychological distress caused by the catastrophe. When she claims that the attacks ripped open a rift in urban spacetime allowing historical ghosts to return-he dismisses her accounts as grief-fueled hallucinations. **CO3**

16. The poem alludes to the Greek myth of Odysseus and his son Telemachus, Vuong overlays this mythic framework with the historical trauma of the Vietnam War and the refugee experience. The bullet hole symbolizes the physical and psychological violence of war that has permanently marked, and ultimately broken, the father. **CO3**

17. On the morning of the Sept 11 attacks, Mrs. Pirelli suffered a heart attack while watching the smoke and flames on television. Because her son worked in the World Trade Center, she was immediately consumed by the terrifying belief that he had burned to death- The rescue team transported her to St. Vincent's Hospital in the fire chief's personal car- her son survived. **CO3**

18. Warsan Shire's powerful poem "Home," the speaker details the racism, and hostility that refugees face upon arriving in the countries where they seek asylum -They are explicitly told to "Go home," and are aggressively labeled as "refugees," "dirty immigrants," and "asylum seekers. **CO4**

19. In Wisława Szymborska's renowned poem "The End and the Beginning,"- cyclical nature of history, the necessity of healing, and the inevitability of human forgetfulness. **CO4**

(5 x 6 = 30)

Part C - Essay

Answer any 2 questions. Each question carries 15 marks.

20. Traditional wars have clear end dates, but an ideological conflict lacks a logical stopping point because the "enemy" is an abstract concept -Society remains in a perpetual state of readiness, blurring the line between peacetime and wartime. **CO1**

21. Achille Mbembe expands upon Michel Foucault's concept of biopower-the state's power to "foster life or disallow it to the point of death"-by shifting the analytical focus directly toward necropower-the sovereign power to dictate who may live and who must die-The war machine reduces human bodies to disposable entities, enforcing total subjugation, transforming citizens into targets, and turning entire regions into spaces where destruction is normalized and self-determination is completely erased. **CO2**

22. In Khaled Hosseini's illustrated poem Sea Prayer, the young boy, Marwan, has known a childhood defined entirely by the Syrian civil war-to shield his son from the absolute terror of the present and the perilous sea crossing ahead, the father uses the act of memory-keeping as an emotional sanctuary. **CO3**

23. In Wisława Szymborska's masterwork "The End and the Beginning," memory and forgetting act as a necessary, interlocking mechanism for human survival. Szymborska presents a profound paradox: while forgetting is a betrayal of the past and a historical danger, it is simultaneously the only psychological engine that allows humanity to heal, rebuild, and move forward after massive trauma. **CO4**

(15 x 2 = 30)